



MARINE BIOLOGIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Marine biologists study life within the world's seas and oceans, conducting research in both the water and in the laboratory to analyze how plants and animals are affected by changes in the environment, some of which are caused by human activities. They often specialize in studying one species of animal or plant and may travel the world to study its habitats and feeding patterns.



SALARY

Junior marine biologist ★★☆☆☆

Senior marine biologist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growth opportunities in sectors including pollution control, biotechnology, and aquaculture • Work available across the world • Competitive job market

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MICROBIOLOGIST** *see pp. 138–139*
- ▶ **ECOLOGIST** *see pp. 172–173*
- ▶ **BIOCHEMIST** Investigates chemical reactions that take place in living organisms. Areas of research include DNA, proteins, drugs, allergies, and disease.
- ▶ **ENVIRONMENTAL CONSERVATIONIST** Works to protect and manage the natural environment in locations such as forests, deserts, and coastal areas.
- ▶ **OCEANOGRAPHER** Conducts scientific research related to the oceans and seas, and how they interact with rivers, glaciers, and the atmosphere. Oceanographers work in waste management, offshore wind farms, coastal construction, and for oil and water companies.

Ocean covers 71 percent of the Earth's surface, but we have explored only 10 percent of them.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Marine life • Oceanography • Palaeontology • Conservation • Biology • Geography • Geology • Chemistry



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in a relevant subject, such as marine biology, zoology, or oceanography, is required.



LIFESTYLE Work hours are often irregular. Field trips are commonplace and may require long-distance travel, often at short notice.



LOCATION Long days at sea are normal when collecting data on field trips, but much of the work is based in a laboratory or an office.



THE REALITIES Activities such as diving and working on board ships are exciting but also physically demanding, and may be dangerous at times.